

Please write clearly in block capitals.

Centre number

Candidate number

Surname

Forename(s)

A-level

ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCE**Paper 2 (Generated practice paper - Set 20)**

Assessed: The living environment, Biological resources, Sustainability, Research methods

Time allowed: 3 hours**Materials**

For this paper you may use:

- a calculator.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen. Pencil should only be used for drawing.
- Fill in the boxes at the top of this page.
- Answer **all** questions 1 to 10 and **one** essay from question 11.
- You must answer the questions in the spaces provided. Do not write outside the box around each page or on blank pages.
- Do all rough work in this book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.

Information

- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- The maximum mark for this paper is 120.
- All questions should be answered in continuous prose.
- You will be assessed on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

For Examiner's Use

Question	Mark
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	
11	
TOTAL	

Answer all questions in the spaces provided.

01 . 1

Explain what is meant by **biomimetics** and describe **three** examples.

[4 marks]

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01 . 2

Explain why many plants produce chemicals that are useful as human medicines, and give **two** examples.

[3 marks]

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01 . 3

Explain why the discovery of medicines is a strong argument for conserving whole habitats rather than individual species.

[2 marks]

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01 . 4

Give **one** example of a wildlife species used in physiological research and the human health issue it helps to understand.

[1 mark]

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10

0 2

Table 1 compares an indigenous mixed broadleaf woodland with a Sitka spruce plantation of the same area in Scotland.

Table 1

Feature	Mixed indigenous woodland	Sitka spruce plantation
Tree species	12	1
Age structure	All ages, dead wood present	All planted in the same year
Planting density	Natural, variable	Close, 2 m spacing
Timber yield / $\text{m}^3 \text{ ha}^{-1} \text{ yr}^{-1}$	4	16
Bird species	38	9
Ground flora species	60	4

0 2

. 1

Use Table 1 to explain why the plantation has a much higher timber yield but far lower biodiversity.

[6 marks]

0 2 . 2

Explain why commercial plantations are felled before the trees reach full size.

[2 marks]

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0 2 . 3

Explain why there is little demand today for coppiced or pollarded wood.

[2 marks]

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10

0 3 . 1

Describe the ecological features of temperate broadleaf woodland and explain how woodland floor plants such as bluebells are adapted to them.

[4 marks]

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0 3 . 2

Explain why an ancient woodland (existing before 1600) usually has higher biodiversity than a recently planted woodland.

[3 marks]

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0 3 . 3

Describe **three** threats to UK broadleaf woodland.

[3 marks]

1

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2

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0 4 . 1

Explain the meaning of each of the following terms and explain why such species are given conservation priority.

[8 marks]

EDGE species

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Endemic species

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Keystone species

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Flagship species

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04 . 2

Explain why the degree of population dispersal is considered when setting priorities.

[2 marks]

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10

05 . 1

Describe **two** case studies of biological control, one successful and one that caused problems.

[4 marks]

05 . 2

Explain how pheromone traps can be used in pest control.

[2 marks]

05 . 3

Explain why the use of antibiotics as growth promoters in livestock is a concern for human health.

[3 marks]

05 . 4

Give **one** way farmers can support crop pollinators.

[1 mark]

10

06 . 1

Explain how each of the following environmental impacts of salmon farming arises and how it can be reduced.

[8 marks]

Overfishing of wild fish for feed

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Sea lice and disease

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Escapes affecting wild gene pools

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Organic waste pollution

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06 . 2

Explain why culling seals and cormorants near fish farms is controversial and give an alternative.

[2 marks]

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07

The Russell formula describes changes in a fish stock: $S_2 = S_1 + (A + G) - (C + M)$, where S_1 and S_2 are the stock biomass at the start and end of the year, A = recruitment of young fish, G = growth, C = catch and M = natural mortality. Table 1 gives estimates for a cod stock.

Table 1

Term	Biomass / thousand tonnes
S_1	600
A	90
G	150
C	220
M	80

07

1 Calculate S_2 and state whether the stock is being fished sustainably.

[2 marks]

Answer

thousand tonnes

07

2 Calculate the maximum catch that would have kept the stock constant.

[1 mark]

Answer

thousand tonnes

07

3 Explain why the catch is the only term in the formula that is easy to measure, and why the others are difficult.

[3 marks]

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07 . 4

Describe how each of the following measures obtained from commercial catches can indicate overfishing.

[4 marks]

Catch per unit fishing effort

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Mean fish size and mean age

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10

08

A new pond was dug in a nature reserve. Table 1 shows the vegetation recorded at intervals over 60 years.

Table 1

Years after creation	Dominant vegetation	Water depth at centre / m
1	Single-celled algae, floating duckweed	2.0
5	Submerged pondweeds; reeds at margins	1.8
15	Reeds and reedmace over most of pond; water lilies	1.0
30	Marsh plants, sedges; willow and alder at edges	0.2
60	Willow / alder carr; oak seedlings	0 (soil waterlogged)

08 . 1

Name the type of sere shown in Table 1 and identify the pioneer species.

[2 marks]

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0	8
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2

 Explain the changes shown in Table 1.

[5 marks]

08 . **3** Explain why a lithosere and a hydrosere in the same region end with the same climax community.

[2 marks]

08 . **4** Describe the early stages of a lithosere.

[1 mark]

10

09 . 1

Give **two** natural processes that are driven by solar energy.

[2 marks]

1

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2

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09 . 2

Explain why natural processes can take place at low temperatures.

[2 marks]

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09 . 3

Give **one** human activity that uses high temperatures to achieve a result that natural systems achieve at low temperature.

[1 mark]

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5

10 . 1

Evaluate the relative importance of ex-situ and in-situ methods in the conservation of endangered species.

[9 marks]

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[illegible]

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10 . **2** State what is meant by **rewilding**.

[1 mark]

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Write an essay on one of the following topics.

$$\boxed{1} \boxed{1} . \boxed{1}$$

Discuss the extent to which the resources and services provided by other species justify the conservation of biodiversity.

[25 marks]

OR

$$\boxed{1} \boxed{1} . \boxed{2}$$

Using tropical coral reefs as an example, discuss how the ecological features of a habitat determine both its importance and its vulnerability to human activities.

[25 marks]

Indicate which question you have answered by writing its number, **11 . 1** or **11 . 2**, at the top of your answer.

[illegible]

END OF QUESTIONS